

1. Does the Integrated Behavioral Model predict charitable giving better than the Theory of Planned Behavior?
2. What is the role of social norms in predicting donation intention?
3. Does past donation behavior predict future charitable giving intention?
4. How do attitude, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control predict volunteer behavior?
5. Is the intention-behavior gap relevant in charitable giving research?
6. Does role identity moderate the relationship between intention and prosocial behavior?

Extended TPB models predict giving better; **social norms** matter, but **moral norms** and **past behavior** are usually stronger.

These six questions break into three facets: model performance, norms and past behavior, and behavior translation including volunteering and identity. The evidence is strongest for **extended TPB** rather than a distinct Integrated Behavioral Model, and weaker for **role identity moderation** specifically.

Model Performance

Standard TPB predicts **charitable intention** well, explaining 44% of variance in a meta-analysis, but it predicts actual giving less well, explaining 19% of behavior (White et al., 2023). Extended or revised TPB models usually perform better because adding **moral norm** and **past behavior** increases explanatory power (Veludo-De-Oliveira et al., 2016; Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018).

- A revised TPB outperformed TRA and standard TPB for **future monetary donation behavior** (Veludo-De-Oliveira et al., 2016).
- In charitable giving, adding **moral norm** raised explained intention variance from 44% to 52% (White et al., 2023).
- There is no direct evidence here that a distinct **Integrated Behavioral Model** outperforms TPB; the closest evidence supports TPB integrated with ELM for ad response contexts, not general giving prediction (Van Steenburg & Spears, 2021).

Norms and Past Behavior

Social norms do predict donation intention, but their effect depends on which norm is measured and in what context. **Subjective or injunctive norms** are often significant, while **descriptive norms** are less consistent, and **moral norms** usually emerge as stronger predictors than social norms alone (White et al., 2023; Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Li et al., 2022).

- Injunctive norms predicted charitable intentions, sometimes about as strongly as attitude (Smith & McSweeney, 2007).
- Descriptive norms were non-significant in one revised TPB study, but significant in health giving and in some experimental donation settings (Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Fehrest et al., 2021; Gugenishvili & Colliander, 2022).
- **Past donation behavior** repeatedly predicts future intention, and sometimes is among the strongest predictors (Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Mittelman & Rojas-Méndez, 2018; Kusuma & Anafisati, 2020).

Behavior Translation

The **intention-behavior gap** is relevant in charitable giving. Intention is the strongest predictor of later giving, but many studies explain intention better than actual behavior, and donation appears more vulnerable to slippage than some other planned behaviors (White et al., 2023; Gugenishvili, 2022).

Outcome	What predicts it best	Main caveat
Donation intention	PBC , moral norm, attitude, subjective norm (White et al., 2023)	Effects vary by donation type (White et al., 2023)
Volunteer intention/behavior	Attitude and PBC are strong; norms also contribute in prosocial domains (Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Lakew et al., 2026)	Direct volunteer-specific evidence here is limited
Intention → behavior	Intention predicts behavior, but imperfectly (Smith & McSweeney, 2007; Gugenishvili, 2022)	Social norms can moderate translation (Gugenishvili, 2022)
Role identity moderation	Some evidence for donor identity affecting action on intentions (Lakew et al., 2026)	No paper here directly tests role identity as the moderator named in the question

FIGURE 1 What the literature supports across prediction, norms, and behavior translation in charitable giving.

Overall, **extended TPB models predict charitable giving better than standard TPB, social norms matter but are usually weaker than moral norms and past behavior**, and the **intention-behavior gap** remains a real limitation, especially when moving from stated intention to actual donation.

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